



PROCEDURE

Transportation of Mental Health Consumers

Scope (Staff):	All staff
Scope (Area):	CAMHS-wide

Child Safe Organisation Statement of Commitment

CAHS commits to being a child safe organisation by applying the National Principles for Child Safe Organisations. This is a commitment to a strong culture supported by robust policies and procedures to reduce the likelihood of harm to children and young people.

This document should be read in conjunction with this [disclaimer](#)

Aim

To outline the procedure for CAMHS clinicians in arranging the transport of children who are under 16 years of age (mental health consumers) to Perth Children's Hospital (PCH) Emergency Department (ED) to facilitate the child's assessment, examination and/or treatment in accordance with the [Mental Health Act 2014 \(WA\)](#) (the MHA).

ACRT staff to read this document in conjunction with the Home and Community Visits Procedure.

Risk

Failure to provide safe and appropriate transport for mental health consumers.

Background

This procedure must be read in conjunction with the following policy documents:

- [WA Health Road-Based Transport for Mental Health Consumers Policy](#).
- [CAMHS Clinical Handover Guideline](#)
- [CAMHS Crisis Connect Entry Protocol](#)
- [PCH Interhospital Patient Transfer Policy](#)

Definitions

Authorised Person: For the purposes of this procedure, the authorised person is the Consultant Psychiatrist, Authorised Mental Health Practitioner (AMHP) or other doctor

who is authorised to make a Referral for Examination by Psychiatrist (Form 1A) and Transport Order (Form 4A) under the MHA.

Carer: A person who provides care or assistance to a person who meets the criteria in s 5(1) of the [Carers Recognition Act 2004 \(WA\)](#). For a child of Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander descent, this may be a person from their kinship group who is recognised under customary laws and traditions as their carer (MHA s 281(2)(b))

Child: A person under 18 years of age (MHA s 4).

Parent: The person(s) who has parental responsibility for the child. Parental responsibility, in relation to a child, means all the duties, powers, responsibilities and authority which, by law, parents have in relation to children (MHA s 4, [Family Law Act 1975 \(Cth\)](#) (FLA) s 61B and [Family Court Act 1997 \(WA\)](#) (FCA) s 68). For the purposes of this guideline, this also includes any legal guardian of the child appointed under the [Guardianship and Administration Act 1990 \(WA\)](#) (GAA) (GAA s 3). Changes to relationships such as parental separation, divorce or remarriage do not alter parental responsibility, unless there is a specific court order changing parental responsibility (FLA s 61C(2), FCA s 69(2))

Transport Officer: A person authorised to carry out a transport order made under the [Mental Health Act 2014 \(WA\)](#).

Transport Order (Form 4A): An authorised person can make a Transport Order (Form 4A) under the [Mental Health Act 2014 \(WA\)](#) if satisfied that a mental health patient needs to be taken to an authorised hospital or other place and no other safe means of taking the person is reasonably available.

Key points

- Under the [National Standards for Mental Health Services](#) (NSMHS) (1.9), CAMHS must uphold the right of the mental health (MH) consumer to be treated in the least restrictive environment to the extent that it does not impose serious risk to the consumer or others.
- When the MH consumer requires involuntary admission, CAMHS must also ensure that transport occurs in the safest and most respectful manner possible ([NSMHS 10.3.7](#)).
- MH consumers have the right to safe transport that minimises restriction to their rights, dignity and self-respect and that reduces the likelihood that they will experience transport that is a traumatic event.
 - This right needs to be balanced with the safety of all concerned and the active management of risk.
- The MH consumer and their parent/carer should be encouraged to make their own decisions and arrangements for transport wherever possible and when clinically appropriate.
- The decision on how to transport a MH consumer is a clinical decision made by the authorised person and must be documented on PSOLIS.

- The authorised person making the decision is responsible for ensuring that a Risk Assessment and Management Plan has been completed prior to the transportation in accordance with the [CAMHS Risk Assessment and Management Policy](#)

Procedure

- Where the authorised person has made the decision that the MH consumer is to be transported for further assessment, examination and/or treatment under the MHA, a [Form 1A](#) (Referral for Examination by Psychiatrist) is completed.
- If the MH consumer is under 16 years of age, they are transported to PCH ED or CAMHS inpatient unit/ward 5A. If they are 16 years or over, they are transported to an alternative Emergency Department or inpatient unit.
- The CAMHS Aboriginal Mental Health Worker will offer cultural consultation to clinicians in the CAMHS service where Aboriginal children and their families present with mental health concerns.
- CAMHS Crisis Connect is contacted on **0466 419 342** to discuss options for transportation with the authorised person as well as to determine bed availability in ED or on Ward 5A.

Transport Options for consumers NOT under a Transport Order (Form 4A)

- Transport options to be considered include the following:
 - Discussion with the parent/carer about transporting the MH consumer using a private vehicle and whether this is the safest and least restrictive option.
 - Clinicians transporting a mental health consumer using a government fleet vehicle where the mental health consumer is known to the treatment team, and there is no clinical or safety requirement for an ambulance.
 - An accompanying staff member in addition to the driver should always be considered in case there is a change in circumstances.
 - Wherever possible the parent / carer needs to accompany the MH consumer if they are being transported using a government fleet vehicle. When a MH consumer is not able to be accompanied by a parent / carer, they must be accompanied by a CAMHS clinician in addition to the driver.
 - Placement of the MH consumer should be in the rear seat not behind the driver.
 - St Johns Ambulance is the 000-service provider for emergency transport when a consumer has an urgent need for medical treatment for a physical or mental illness and where there is an urgent need for clinical

observation. For more information see the [PCH Interhospital Patient Transfer Policy](#).

- Clinicians transporting mental health consumers must refer to the CAMHS Clinical Handover Guideline for information on handover to the receiving service.
- If it is determined that none of the above options are clinically appropriate and/or there are safety or risk issues, an authorised person can make a Transport Order (4A) under the MHA.

Procedure for Transportation of MH Consumers under a Transport Order (Form 4A)

- An authorised person cannot make a Transport Order unless satisfied that no other safe means of transporting the MH consumer is reasonably available.
- Transportation of MH consumers under the MHA, where a Transport Order (Form 4A) is in place, is provided by a Transport Officer as per the contracted arrangement with WA Health.
 - Contracted Transport Officers must be contacted prior to requesting WA Police assistance.
 - The current provider for Mental Health Transport Services between the community and PCH ED, for patients under a Transport Order, is Wilson Medic One.
 - For more information including booking details, operating hours and attendance times please refer to the [Department of Health Buyers Guide for Mental Health Patient Transport Services](#) or visit the [Mental Health Transport page on HealthPoint \(EMHS\)](#)
- At the time of issuing a Transport Order (Form 4A) the authorised person must complete a [Mental Health Patient Transport Risk Rating Form](#).
- A **Detention Order** (Form 3A) can be issued by the authorised person when the MH consumer needs to be detained whilst awaiting the Transport Officer.
- If emergency psychiatric treatment is required to manage agitation whilst awaiting the Transport Officer, the authorised person completes a **Record of Emergency Psychiatric Treatment** (Form 9A).
- The CAMHS service making the referral for assessment and arranging the transportation must ensure there is a safe and appropriate place for the MH consumer to exit the clinic and meet the Transport Officer.
 - The parent/carer must be informed that the MH consumer is being transported and that they are not able to accompany the Transport Officer in the vehicle.

- Transport Officers (and WA Police if applicable) must be provided with a copy of the Form 1A and Transport Order (Form 4A) and the [Mental Health Patient Transport Risk Rating Form](#) as part of the handover from the service.
- The authorised person issuing a Transport Order (Form 4A) must minimise the use of WA Police. The use of WA Police must be the least preferred option and must only be requested if a child continues to pose a significant imminent risk of harm to themselves or to another person after appropriate clinical management and transport risk management strategies have been applied.
- The process for complaints and feedback on the contracted Mental Health Transport Service is outlined in the [Department of Health Buyers Guide for Mental Health Patient Transport Services](#). The relevant CAMHS Director should be included in any email correspondence.

Critical Incident Impact Management

- Where an incident has occurred that requires an issuing of a Transport Order, appropriate support must be arranged for those CAMHS employees who were involved.
- This may include defusing or debriefing consult [Staying Well \(sharepoint.com\)](#)

Related CAHS internal policies, procedures and guidelines
CAMHS Clinical Handover Guideline
PCH Interhospital Patient Transfer Policy
CAMHS Risk Assessment and Management Policy
Staying Well CAHS Work Health Safety and Wellbeing

References and related external legislation, policies, and guidelines
Mental Health Act 2014 (WA)
WA Health Road-Based Transport for Mental Health Consumers Policy.
National Standards for Mental Health Services
Carers Recognition Act 2004 (WA)
Family Law Act 1975 (Cth)
Family Court Act 1997 (WA)

[Guardianship and Administration Act 1990 \(WA\)](#)

Useful resources (including related forms)

[MHA Forms](#)

[Mental Health Transport page on HealthPoint \(EMHS\)](#)

[Department of Health Buyers Guide for Mental Health Patient Transport Services](#)

[Mental Health Patient Transport Risk Rating Form](#)

[Home and Community Visits Procedure](#)

This document can be made available in alternative formats on request.

File Path:			
Document Owner:	CAMHS Director Clinical Services		
Reviewer / Team:	CAMHS Policy; Service Fremantle CAMHS; Coordinator of Nursing Community CAMHS; Coordinator of Nursing Acute CAMHS; CAMHS Aboriginal Mental Health Coordinator; HoD PCH CAMHS; Director Community CAMHS; HoD Community CAMHS, ACRT		
Date First Issued:	28/06/2023	Last Reviewed:	12/12/2024
Amendment Dates:	17/12/2024	Next Review Date:	28/06/2026
Approved by:	Director Clinical Services	Date:	08/01/2025
Endorsed by:	CAMHS Executive Clinical Governance Committee	Date:	08/01/2025
Standards Applicable:	NSQHS Standards:  Child Safe Standards: 1, 2, 3, 4, 8, 10.		

Printed or personally saved electronic copies of this document are considered uncontrolled



Healthy kids, healthy communities

Compassion

Excellence

Collaboration

Accountability

Equity

Respect

Neonatology | Community Health | Mental Health | Perth Children's Hospital

